

HIGH HYDRATION SOURDOUGH



MAKES 1 loaf	ACTIVE TIME 30 min	REST 8-10 h bulk, then 1-6 h cold	OVEN 450F, 60 min total
ENERGY COST \$3.10 (60 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)		PRICE \$8	

DETAILS

- Tags: vegan

INGREDIENTS

50 g	Active starter
375 g	Warm water
500 g	Bread flour
9 g	Fine sea salt

METHOD

1. Thursday to Friday, feed the starter.
2. Saturday evening, make the dough. Sunday morning, bake.
3. Mix the water with the starter. Form a rough dough and rest 1 hour.
4. Work it into a ball, 15 to 20 seconds.
5. Bulk rise 8 to 10 hours at room temperature.
6. Dimple the dough all over with floured fingertips.
7. Gently shape into a round and rest 5 to 10 minutes.
8. Flip the dough and shape again, then flip it over. Shape once more and flip back.
9. Into the bread basket, seam side up.
10. Cover and refrigerate 1 hour, up to 6 if needed.
11. Let it sit at room temperature while the oven heats. Preheat to 450F.
12. Bake 20 minutes covered, 30 minutes with the lid off, then 10 minutes directly.

NOTES

The schedule is built around a weekend: feed Thursday and Friday, mix Saturday night, bake Sunday morning. Seam side up in the basket, so it goes seam down into the pot. The three-stage bake is 60 minutes total, longer than most recipes, and the final 10 minutes out of the pot is what sets the crust.

LEARNINGS

- 375 g of water against 500 g of flour is 75% hydration before the starter, which is where the name comes from. Counting the starter as half flour and half water, total hydration lands near 76%.
- The preheat line in the notebook has one temperature struck through with 450F written after it, so 450F is what is recorded here. Worth settling whether the struck-out figure was a hotter preheat that then drops for the bake.